

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

SATURDAY, AUGUST 2, 2025

Trump blasts jobs data, fires official

Economists criticize dismissal and president's claims of a 'rigged' report

By Ben Casselman and Tony Romm
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump unleashed his fury about weakness in the labor market on Friday, saying without evidence that the data were “rigged” and that he was firing the Senate-confirmed Department of Labor official responsible for pulling together the numbers each month.

In a long post on social media, Trump said he had directed his team to fire Erika McEntarfer, the commissioner of the Bureau of Labor Statistics, who was confirmed on a bipartisan basis in 2024.

Emily Liddel, an associate commissioner for the bureau, confirmed late Friday that McEntarfer had been fired and that William Wiatrowski, the deputy commissioner, would serve as acting commissioner.

The president fired McEntarfer after the bureau released monthly jobs data showing surprisingly weak hiring in July and large downward revisions to job growth in the previous two months. Economists widely interpreted the report as evidence that Trump's policies were beginning to take a toll on the economy, though the president insisted in a subsequent post that the country was “doing GREAT!”

Lori Chavez-DeRemer, the labor secretary, **TARIFFS, Page A7**

Kraft reveals income but not tax returns

Mayoral hopeful says he made \$6.3m last year

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

Boston mayoral candidate Josh Kraft revealed Friday that he earned \$6.3 million in 2024, but shed little light on his broader financial situation, as his campaign declined to detail the sources of that income and said it would not provide his full tax returns.

Though Kraft told the Globe earlier this year he would release his tax returns, a spokesperson said on Friday the campaign will not. In lieu of the documents themselves, the campaign on Friday provided a two-page summary from the firm Ernst & Young LLP, which is preparing Kraft's taxes, according to the unsigned document.

According to the brief document — which provided the public with the most detailed look yet of the candidate's finances — Kraft earned \$6.5 million in 2023. He reported giving \$297,000 to charity in 2023 and \$269,000 in 2024, amounting to between 4 and 5 percent of his income in those years. His total federal and state income tax was \$2,188,000 in 2023, according to the document, and was projected to be \$2,570,000 in 2024.

KRAFT, Page A6

ROCHESTER ENTERS ITS RODEO ERA

Spectators and riders from across New England gathered in Rochester for the region's sole rodeo season. Many of the professional bull riders at the rodeo are from Brazil and develop strong bonds as they compete on the Professional Bull Riders circuit. At right, Augusto Vieira, a novice rider, leaped off a bull after a long ride. Below, spectators, many wearing cowboy hats and other items reflecting rodeo culture, watched from the stands. **B2.**



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

‘We’re saving taxpayers hundreds of millions of dollars and putting families on a path to self-sustainability.’

GOVERNOR MAURA HEALEY

Governor ends shelter state of emergency, closes hotel sites

Amid immigration drop, Healey cites restrictions, aid programs for move

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

After spending her entire time in office grappling with how to rein in the state's overwhelmed shelter system, Governor Maura Healey announced Friday the closure of all hotel shelters and the end of a state of emergency she declared in August 2023, saying they are no longer needed after state lawmakers earlier this year passed policies that restricted who can access the state's emergency shelter system.

The announcement marks a notable milestone in the state's years-long effort to address a wave of migrants fleeing political strife, street violence, and economic collapse in their home countries that collided with an intractable housing crisis to overwhelm the state-run shelter system. The crisis pushed the cost of running the shelter system up to \$1 billion a year, rankled towns and cities around the state, and left state leaders grappling for ways to rein in the system without leaving families

sleeping in the airport or on the street.

Healey, in announcing the end to the state of emergency, cited job training programs, housing assistance, and other support programs as reasons why fewer families are seeking refuge in the shelter system. In particular, the governor said, her administration's actions meant the state no longer needed to put families in the hotels and motels the state contracted with as the system's population ballooned in 2023 and 2024.

A significant downturn in national immigration trends amid President Trump's crack-down on migrants has also contributed to easing the stress on the system.

The hotel closures come months ahead of the state's self-imposed, end-of-the-year deadline and are a result of “my reforms and our efforts to help families get jobs and stable housing,” Healey said in a statement.

“We're saving taxpayers hundreds of millions of dollars and putting families on a path to self-sustainability,” she said.

In addition to the closure of hotel shelters, shelters located at the former Bay State Correctional Center and the Chelsea Rapid Shelter site have also closed.

Just three families were using the hotel **SHELTERS, Page A10**

State to pay \$66m for St. Elizabeth's complex

Settles eminent domain claim with Steward lender

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

The state has reached a settlement with the investment firm that owned the Brighton campus of St. Elizabeth's Medical Center, agreeing to pay a total of \$66 million to take the hospital complex by eminent domain.

That price for the facility, currently operated by Boston Medical Center, is nearly 15 times the \$4.5 million that Massachusetts regulators initially offered last year. It's also far below the nearly \$200 million that Apollo Asset Management had sought in court proceedings, citing the appraised value of the hospital and the 14-acre campus it sits on.

The settlement, documented in federal disclosures by an Apollo subsidiary, closes another costly chapter in the state's efforts to wrest control of Steward Health Care's failing Massachusetts hospital network and keep as many of the facilities open under new management as possible. In a **HOSPITAL, Page A10**

How will your garden grow?

As the New England climate warms, what you plant matters

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF
and Lily Cowper
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Jenica Allen started to redo her yard, there were certain factors she took into account, like how the land has a gentle slope but is fully exposed to the sun. Then, there's also the fact the weather in New England isn't what it once was. Some plants native to northern New England that thrive in cooler

summers with more predictable rain patterns aren't necessarily well suited anymore, while some plants from slightly south of here are now on the table.

But as an ecologist at the University of Massachusetts Amherst, Allen knew just where to turn to find native plants, as well as so-called near-native plants that are able to thrive in a changing climate.

A senior research fellow, Allen is part of a team from UMass and the Northeast Regional Invasive Species and Climate Change Management Network that recently released a climate-smart garden- **GARDEN, Page B4**



President Trump's Mideast envoy visited a food distribution site in the Gaza Strip operated by an Israeli-backed American contractor whose efforts to deliver food have been marred by violence and controversy. **A5.**

The Corporation for Public Broadcasting announced it would take steps toward its own closure after being defunded by Congress. **D1.**

New Hampshire has become the first state in New England to ban gender-affirming care medication for minors after Governor Kelly Ayotte signed House Bill 377 into law. **B1.**

President Trump said that he had “ordered two nuclear submarines” to be repositioned in response to online threats from Russia's former president, Dmitry Medvedev. **A6.**



Out and out

Saturday: Sunny, pleasant. High: 72-77. Low: 60-65.

Sunday: Sunny, warmer. High: 81-86. Low: 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:38 Sunset: 8:02

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 308, NO. 33

*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00

